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Dubai Media Office

MOHAMMED OPENS NEW FNC SESSION

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, opened the new session of the Federal National Council yesterday. Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, also attended the opening ceremony. **SEE ALSO P6**

Eight-day NYE extravaganza in Dubai to get a Bollywood touch

Fireworks, light shows, Dubai Fountain to wow New Year's Eve visitors

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Just when you thought Dubai's New Year's Eve celebrations couldn't get any bigger, Emaar has raised the bar once again. The developer behind the Burj Khalifa has unveiled plans for an eight-day extravaganza set to light up Downtown Dubai from December 31 to January 7.

This year, the world's tallest tower and its surroundings will be transformed into one of the grandest open-air stages ever created, blending art, technology and entertainment in true Dubai fashion, according to Emaar.

Dubai New Year's Eve celebrations typically attract a massive crowd, with attendance at Downtown Dubai alone reaching a record 1.7 million people in past years.

This crowd size notably surpasses the 1 million visitors that is originally expected, making it one of the world's most popular

New Year's Eve events. In addition to the physical attendees, over 2 billion people have been reached via live video streams during these celebrations.

Burj Park at the heart of action

Burj Park will be the heart of the action, offering a ticketed experience with a special Bollywood touch curated in collaboration with Frontstage, part of Shah Rukh Khan's Red Chillies Entertainment.

Expect blockbuster energy — with live performances, colourful parades and a festival atmosphere that brings the spirit of Indian cinema to Dubai's most famous backdrop.

Tickets for Burj Park are priced at Dh950 for adults and Dh550 for children aged 5 to 12, with free access for kids under five.

The celebration doesn't stop at Burj Park. A grand parade will sweep through Downtown Dubai, featuring huge floats, illuminated puppets and performers celebrating the city's creativity and cultural diversity.

Dubai tourist arrivals hit record 15.7m

HOTEL OCCUPANCY RISES TO 79.4%
AMID EMIRATE'S TOURISM MOMENTUM

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai welcomed a record 15.7 million international visitors between January and October 2025, according to the latest tourism performance data from the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism (DET).

The figure represents a 5 per cent increase from the 14.96 million international tourists recorded during the same period last year.

In October alone, the city hosted about 1.75 million visitors, averaging more than 56,000 tourists per day. Western Europe remained Dubai's leading source market, accounting for 21 per cent of arrivals — around 3.26 million tourists — during the first ten months of 2025.

GCC ranks second

The GCC ranked second with 16 per cent (2.5 million visitors), followed by South Asia with 15 per cent (2.33 million).

Russia, the CIS and Eastern Europe collectively contributed another 15 per cent, representing more than 2.27 million visitors.

The Middle East and North Africa region recorded 1.74 million tourists, or 11 per cent of the total. North and Southeast Asia together accounted for about 1.47 million visitors (9 per cent).

Arrivals from the Americas

56,000

tourists per day
was the average in
October alone

21%

of tourists were
from Western
Europe, the highest

reached 1.1 million (7 per cent), Africa contributed 698,000 (4 per cent), and Australasia added 329,000 visitors (2 per cent).

By the end of October 2025, Dubai's hotel inventory stood at more than 152,800 rooms across 820 establishments, slightly up from 152,500 rooms in 827 properties year-on-year.

Average hotel occupancy reached 79.4 per cent between January and October 2025, compared with 77 per cent during the same period last year. Luxury five-star hotels accounted for 36 per cent of total supply, offering around 55,000 rooms across 172 properties.

Four-star hotels represented 28 per cent (43,200 rooms in 193 hotels), while one- to three-star hotels comprised 19 per cent (29,100 rooms across 276 properties).



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